

ARTOFEST

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Title and Introduction

- Today we are presenting our project, ArtoFest.
- ArtoFest is a cross-platform festival discovery and planning application designed to bring festival information into one central platform.
- Rather than users having to search across multiple websites, ArtoFest provides a single place where users can browse, filter, and interact with festival data in a more structured and user-friendly way.
- In this presentation, we will explain the problem we identified, how we planned the project, the key design decisions we made, and finally demonstrate the working prototype.

The Problem (Paul)

- The problem we identified is that festival information is often fragmented across multiple platforms.
- Users typically need to search across different websites to find festival dates, locations, and official links, which can be time-consuming and inefficient.
- While there are existing platforms available, they tend to focus heavily on listing data rather than supporting the user's overall experience.
- For example, many platforms do not allow users to easily compare festivals, organise them, or plan around them.
- As a result, there is a clear gap for a platform that not only provides festival data, but also presents it in a way that is easy to explore, filter, and build plans around.

Project Planning Process (Paul)

- To manage the project effectively, we began by clearly defining the scope, objectives, and exclusions.
- This was important to ensure that we stayed focused on delivering a realistic and achievable MVP, rather than attempting too many features at once.
- The project was then broken down into phases, including planning, research, design, development, testing, and evaluation.
- We used a structured approach to assign roles within the team, with each member focusing on a specific area such as frontend, backend, design, or project management.
- Throughout the project, we maintained regular communication and tracked progress to ensure tasks were being completed.
- We also identified risks early on, such as time constraints and technical complexity, and managed these by prioritising core features first.
- This approach allowed us to deliver a working system even if some advanced features had to be postponed.



Design Goals (Favour)

- The primary design goal was to create a clean, user-focused interface that is easy to understand and navigate.
- Instead of building a complex or data-heavy platform, we focused on clarity and simplicity.
- The interface needed to feel approachable for a wide range of users, including people who may not be familiar with festival platforms.
- Another key goal was consistency across platforms. Since the application is built using React Native, it needs to work well on both web and mobile devices.
- This meant carefully considering layout, spacing, and navigation to ensure the experience remains consistent regardless of screen size.

Key Design Decisions (Favour)

- To support these goals, several important design decisions were made.
- Firstly, we used a card-based layout to display festivals. This allows users to quickly scan information such as the festival name, location, and date without feeling overwhelmed.
- We also included a hero section on the homepage to immediately communicate the purpose of the platform.
- Consistent spacing, typography, and colour themes were also used throughout the application to improve readability and create a more professional appearance.

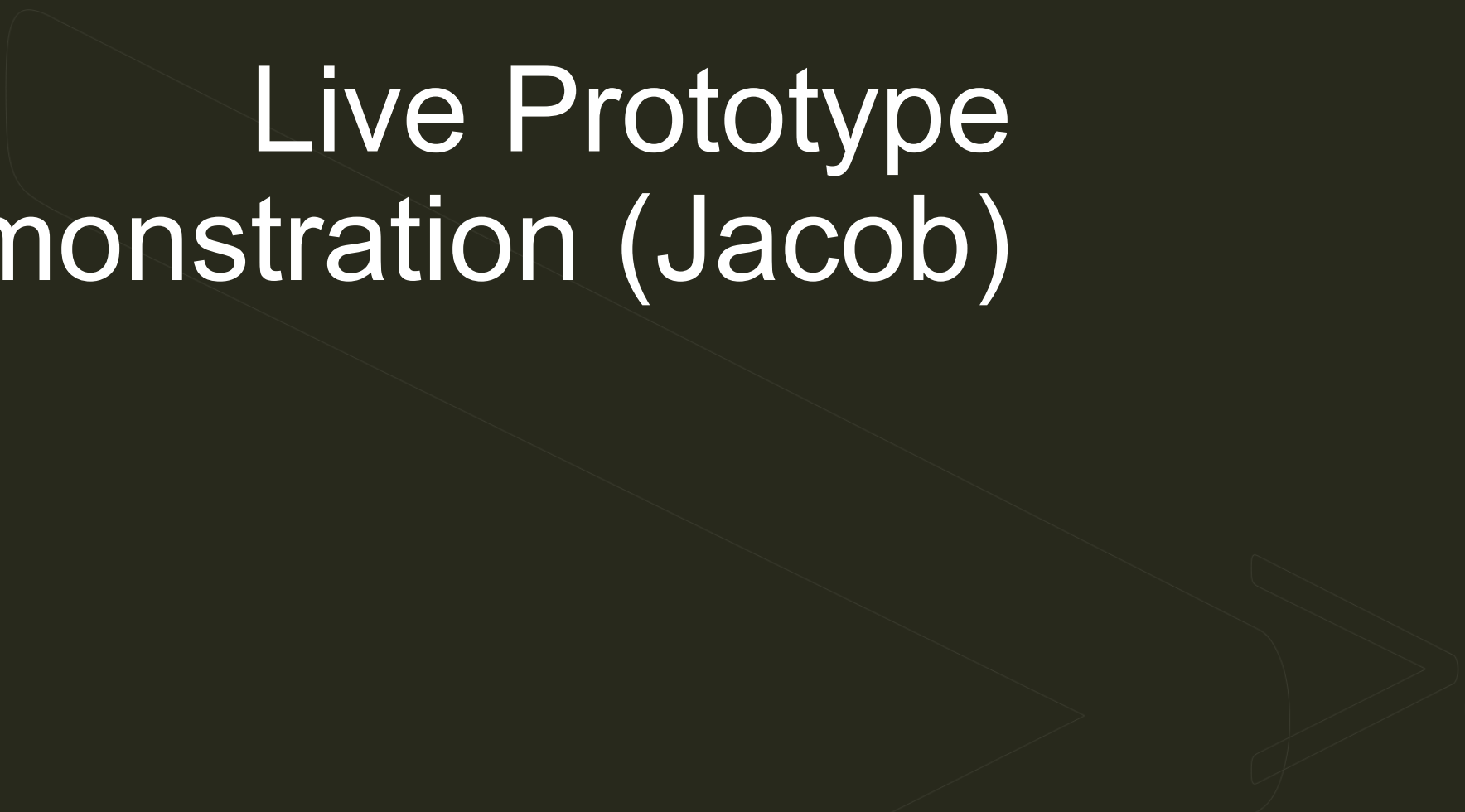


Defining the MVP (Jacob)

- Our minimum viable product focuses on delivering the core functionality of the system.
- The main features include browsing festivals, filtering by country, month, and art form, and viewing detailed information about each festival.
- Users are also able to create an account, log in, and save festivals to a personal wishlist.
- This wishlist can then be organised by month, allowing users to begin planning their festival schedule.
- We also implemented a streaming feature, which allows users to view related festival content, adding another layer to the platform.
- Some features, such as AI-based planning and full booking integration, were originally considered but were not completed due to time constraints and technical limitations.
- Instead, these are included as placeholders or proof-of-concept features, showing how the system could be expanded in the future.
- This approach allowed us to deliver a realistic and functional MVP without overextending the scope.



Live Prototype Demonstration (Jacob)



Technical Approach (Steven)



From a technical perspective, the system is built using React Native and Expo, which allows us to use a single codebase for both web and mobile platforms.



The frontend communicates with a backend API, which provides festival data, authentication, wishlist functionality, and streaming content.



This means the application is dynamic, as data is loaded from the backend rather than being hard-coded into the frontend.



The system also uses token-based authentication, which allows users to log in and securely access their personal wishlist.



The overall architecture is designed to be scalable, meaning that additional features can be added in the future without needing to completely rebuild the system.



For example, future improvements could include integrating external APIs for travel and accommodation, or adding a content management system so that festival data can be updated more easily.

Conclusion (Steven)

- In conclusion, we have successfully developed a working and responsive MVP that meets the main objectives of the project.
- The platform allows users to discover festivals, view detailed information, and begin planning using account-based features such as the wish list.
- Throughout the project, risks were managed by focusing on core functionality and prioritising the most important features.
- While some advanced features were not fully implemented, they have been considered and partially designed, providing a clear direction for future development.
- Future improvements include completing the AI planner feature, improving image quality and visual polish, integrating real booking and travel services, and deploying the system for wider use.
- Overall, ArtoFest provides a strong foundation for a full festival planning platform.
- Thank you for listening.